

“Strategic Failure at BJP: An Organizational Behaviour Analysis”



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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Bharat Jurisprudence & Projects (BJP) established an international expansion task force led by CEO Nelkantha with representation from finance, strategy, operations, marketing, HR, risk, and corporate communications. Despite optimistic projections, the initiative failed due to systemic organizational behaviour issues rather than purely strategic or market miscalculations.

Key contributing factors included perceptual selectivity, political coalitions, group decision-making biases, centralized leadership, communication distortions, and escalating interdepartmental conflict. These elements interacted to suppress dissent, distort information, and weaken decision quality.

This report concludes that BJP's failure was a **behavioural and governance breakdown** and recommends a structural-behavioural corrective framework focusing on distributed decision-making, transparent communication, formal risk oversight, leadership development, and conflict management systems.

BACKGROUND

To drive global growth, BJP formed a cross-functional task force comprising:

- Nelkantha — Chief Executive Officer
- Debkanta — Chief Financial Officer
- Subhrangshu — Strategy Head
- Apabrita — HR Director
- Abhimanyu — Operations Head
- Rajesh — Marketing Head
- Richik — Risk Analyst
- Debosmita — Corporate Communications Lead

Initial projections supported rapid expansion; however, risk concerns raised by the Risk Analyst were not incorporated into strategic deliberations. Informal alliances emerged, communication quality deteriorated, and interdepartmental tensions intensified under a centralized leadership structure.

ANALYTICAL FRAMEWORK

The analysis applies core Organizational Behaviour dimensions:

1. Perception and cognition
2. Power and politics
3. Group decision-making dynamics
4. Leadership style
5. Communication processes
6. Conflict management

BEHAVIOURAL ANALYSIS

Perceptual Selectivity

Senior leadership exhibited selective perception by prioritizing data aligned with expansion ambitions while discounting contrary evidence. Risk signals identified by the Risk Analyst were marginalized because they conflicted with the prevailing growth narrative.

Implications:

- Reinforced unrealistic assumptions
- Reduced strategic vigilance
- Increased vulnerability to external uncertainty

Political Behaviour

Informal coalitions between the Operations and Marketing heads shaped information flows and influenced strategic priorities. Data was selectively shared to support departmental agendas, creating asymmetry in decision inputs.

Implications:

- Erosion of objectivity
- Weak alignment with organizational goals
- Decision-making driven by influence rather than evidence

Group Decision Biases

The task force displayed several collective cognitive biases:

- **Groupthink:** Pressure to maintain consensus discouraged dissenting opinions
- **Overconfidence:** Early projections were treated as certainties
- **Escalation of Commitment:** Continued resource allocation despite emerging risks

Implications:

Decision robustness declined as critical evaluation mechanisms weakened.

Leadership Style

CEO Nelkantha's centralized and directive leadership concentrated authority and limited participative decision-making. While this approach improved speed, it reduced psychological safety and discouraged upward feedback.

Implications:

- Reduced diversity of viewpoints
- Increased dependence on leader assumptions
- Limited adaptive capacity

Communication Distortions

The Corporate Communications Lead identified upward filtering and framing of information to align with leadership expectations.

Implications:

- Incomplete situational awareness at the executive level
- Misalignment between strategy and operational realities
- Amplification of cognitive and political biases

Conflict Processes

Initial task-related disagreements evolved into relationship conflict as trust declined. Resource competition and perceived favoritism intensified tensions across departments.

Implications:

- Reduced collaboration
- Slower execution
- Defensive decision-making

Integrated Diagnosis

The strategic failure resulted from a reinforcing cycle:

1. Centralized leadership limited open debate
2. Perceptual bias shaped optimistic assumptions
3. Political alliances controlled information
4. Communication distortions obscured risks
5. Group biases reinforced consensus
6. Conflict undermined coordination

This interaction created a systemic governance failure rather than isolated individual errors.

STRUCTURAL-BEHAVIOURAL CORRECTIVE FRAMEWORK

Structural Recommendations

a. Distributed Decision Governance

Establish cross-functional decision councils with clearly defined accountability (RACI framework).

b. Independent Risk Oversight

Create a formal risk review committee with authority to challenge strategic assumptions.

c. Transparent Information Systems

Implement standardized reporting dashboards to ensure data consistency and accessibility.

d. Formal Conflict Resolution Channels

Introduce mediation mechanisms and escalation protocols for interdepartmental disputes.

Behavioural Recommendations

a. Foster Psychological Safety

Encourage evidence-based dissent through leadership training and inclusive meeting practices.

b. Bias Mitigation Tools

Adopt pre-mortem analysis, scenario planning, and devil's advocate roles in major decisions.

c. Align Incentives

Shift performance metrics from departmental targets to enterprise-wide outcomes.

d. Leadership Development

Transition toward participative and transformational leadership behaviours emphasizing collaboration and empowerment.

IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

Short Term (0–3 months)

- Conduct organizational behaviour audit
- Establish risk governance structure
- Introduce transparent reporting

Medium Term (3–12 months)

- Leadership capability development
- Redesign decision processes
- Align cross-functional KPIs

Long Term (1–2 years)

- Culture transformation initiatives
- Continuous feedback and learning systems
- Institutionalization of behavioural governance

CONCLUSION

The failure of BJP's international expansion initiative was primarily driven by behavioural and governance deficiencies rather than strategic intent alone. Selective perception, internal politics, group decision biases, centralized leadership, communication breakdowns, and unmanaged conflict collectively impaired decision quality and execution.

By implementing an integrated structural–behavioural framework emphasizing transparency, distributed authority, rigorous risk evaluation, and collaborative leadership, BJP can strengthen strategic resilience and improve future decision outcomes.

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